

Monitoring in Anesthesia MCQ – Chapter 6

Source: Short Textbook of Anesthesia – Ajay Yadav

Section 3: Quintessential in Anesthesia (Chapter 6)

50 Questions • 30 Minutes

Instructions:

- Each question has 4 options (A, B, C, D).
- The correct answer is shown on the right side of each question.
- Detailed explanations with textbook page references are at the end.

Questions

Q1. Which of the following is a method of clinical monitoring during anesthesia?

- A. Pulse oximetry
- B. Observation of skin color, pupil size, and respiratory pattern
- C. Invasive arterial pressure
- D. BIS monitoring

Ans: B

Q2. Clinical signs of adequate depth of anesthesia include all EXCEPT:

- A. Stable heart rate and blood pressure
- B. Absence of sweating and lacrimation
- C. BIS value of 40–60
- D. Central and constricted pupils

Ans: C

Q3. Dilated pupils during anesthesia may indicate:

- A. Adequate depth of anesthesia
- B. Light anesthesia, hypoxia, or hypercarbia
- C. Excessive muscle relaxation
- D. Hypothermia

Ans: B

Q4. The minimum mandatory monitoring standards during anesthesia include all EXCEPT:

- A. Pulse oximetry
- B. ECG
- C. Capnography
- D. Cardiac output monitoring

Ans: D

Q5. ECG monitoring during anesthesia primarily detects:

- A. Cardiac output
- B. Arrhythmias, ischemia, and heart rate
- C. Blood pressure
- D. Venous return

Ans: B

Q6. Which ECG lead is most sensitive for detecting intraoperative myocardial ischemia?

- A. Lead I
- B. Lead II
- C. Lead V5
- D. Lead aVR

Ans: C

Q7. Lead II on ECG is preferred during anesthesia for monitoring:

- A. Left ventricular ischemia
- B. P waves and inferior wall ischemia
- C. Right bundle branch block
- D. Pericardial effusion

Ans: B

Q8. Non-invasive blood pressure (NIBP) measurement by oscillometric method measures: A. Only systolic pressure directly B. Mean arterial pressure directly, then calculates systolic and diastolic C. Only diastolic pressure directly D. Cardiac output	Ans: B
Q9. Invasive arterial blood pressure monitoring is indicated in all EXCEPT: A. Major cardiovascular surgery B. Patients requiring frequent arterial blood gas analysis C. Minor ambulatory surgery in healthy patients D. Patients with severe hemodynamic instability	Ans: C
Q10. The most common site for invasive arterial cannulation is the: A. Brachial artery B. Radial artery C. Femoral artery D. Dorsalis pedis artery	Ans: B
Q11. Allen's test is performed before radial artery cannulation to assess: A. Venous drainage of the hand B. Adequacy of collateral circulation from the ulnar artery C. Nerve supply to the hand D. Patency of the brachial artery	Ans: B
Q12. Central venous pressure (CVP) monitoring catheter tip should ideally be positioned at: A. Right atrium B. Junction of superior vena cava and right atrium C. Right ventricle D. Pulmonary artery	Ans: B
Q13. Normal CVP value is: A. 0–2 mmHg B. 2–8 mmHg (3–11 cm H₂O) C. 15–20 mmHg D. 25–30 mmHg	Ans: B
Q14. CVP monitoring is useful for assessing: A. Left ventricular function B. Right heart filling pressure and intravascular volume status C. Pulmonary artery pressure D. Cerebral perfusion pressure	Ans: B

Q15. The pulmonary artery catheter (Swan-Ganz catheter) can measure all EXCEPT: A. Pulmonary artery pressure B. Cardiac output by thermodilution C. Pulmonary capillary wedge pressure D. Intracranial pressure	Ans: D
Q16. Pulmonary capillary wedge pressure (PCWP) is a surrogate for: A. Right atrial pressure B. Left atrial pressure and left ventricular end-diastolic pressure C. Systemic vascular resistance D. Pulmonary vascular resistance	Ans: B
Q17. Pulse oximetry measures: A. Partial pressure of oxygen in blood B. Functional oxygen saturation of hemoglobin (SpO₂) C. Oxygen content of blood D. Dissolved oxygen in plasma	Ans: B
Q18. Pulse oximetry works on the principle of: A. Fluorescence B. Beer-Lambert law (spectrophotometry with two wavelengths of light) C. Piezoelectric effect D. Wheatstone bridge	Ans: B
Q19. Which of the following causes a falsely low pulse oximetry reading? A. Carbon monoxide poisoning B. Methylene blue dye injection C. Anemia D. Jaundice	Ans: B
Q20. Capnography measures: A. Oxygen saturation B. End-tidal carbon dioxide (EtCO₂) concentration C. Tidal volume D. Airway pressure	Ans: B
Q21. Normal end-tidal CO₂ (EtCO₂) value is approximately: A. 10–20 mmHg B. 35–45 mmHg C. 60–80 mmHg D. 5–10 mmHg	Ans: B
Q22. A sudden drop in EtCO₂ to zero during anesthesia most likely indicates: A. Bronchospasm B. Circuit disconnection or esophageal intubation C. Hyperventilation D. Increased cardiac output	Ans: B

Q23. A gradual rise in EtCO₂ during anesthesia may indicate: A. Hyperventilation B. Hypoventilation, increased CO₂ production (malignant hyperthermia), or rebreathing C. Pulmonary embolism D. Cardiac arrest	Ans: B
Q24. Capnography works on the principle of: A. Mass spectrometry B. Infrared absorption spectroscopy C. Piezoelectric effect D. Paramagnetic analysis	Ans: B
Q25. Mainstream capnography differs from sidestream in that: A. It samples gas away from the patient circuit B. The sensor is placed directly in the breathing circuit (at the airway) C. It has a longer response time D. It is less accurate	Ans: B
Q26. Spirometry during anesthesia can measure all EXCEPT: A. Tidal volume B. Minute ventilation C. Compliance and resistance D. Cardiac output	Ans: D
Q27. Airway pressure monitoring helps detect all EXCEPT: A. Circuit disconnection B. Bronchospasm C. Endobronchial intubation D. Myocardial ischemia	Ans: D
Q28. Oxygen analyzers in the anesthetic circuit commonly use which principle? A. Infrared absorption B. Paramagnetic or galvanic cell (fuel cell) principle C. Mass spectrometry only D. Colorimetric detection	Ans: B
Q29. The normal core body temperature range during anesthesia should be maintained at: A. 34–35°C B. 36–37.5°C C. 38–39°C D. 32–34°C	Ans: B

Q30. Sites for core temperature monitoring include all EXCEPT: A. Nasopharynx B. Distal esophagus C. Tympanic membrane D. Axilla	Ans: D
Q31. Perioperative hypothermia is defined as core temperature below: A. 37°C B. 36°C C. 35°C D. 34°C	Ans: B
Q32. Consequences of perioperative hypothermia include all EXCEPT: A. Impaired coagulation B. Increased wound infection C. Shivering and increased oxygen consumption D. Decreased duration of neuromuscular blockade	Ans: D
Q33. Malignant hyperthermia is suspected when temperature monitoring shows: A. Gradual decrease in temperature B. Rapid and unexplained rise in temperature with rising EtCO₂ C. Stable temperature throughout D. Temperature of 36.5°C	Ans: B
Q34. The mechanism of redistribution hypothermia in the first hour of anesthesia is: A. Excessive fluid administration B. Heat redistribution from core to peripheral compartment due to vasodilation C. Cold operating room only D. Shivering	Ans: B
Q35. Neuromuscular monitoring is used to assess: A. Depth of anesthesia B. Degree of neuromuscular blockade and recovery from muscle relaxants C. Blood pressure D. Cerebral activity	Ans: B
Q36. The most commonly used nerve for peripheral nerve stimulation in neuromuscular monitoring is: A. Median nerve B. Ulnar nerve (adductor pollicis response) C. Radial nerve D. Femoral nerve	Ans: B

Q37. Train-of-four (TOF) stimulation consists of: A. Single twitch at 1 Hz B. Four supramaximal stimuli at 2 Hz (every 0.5 seconds) C. Tetanic stimulation at 50 Hz D. Double burst stimulation	Ans: B
Q38. A TOF ratio of greater than 0.9 indicates: A. Complete neuromuscular block B. Adequate recovery from neuromuscular blockade (safe to extubate) C. Need for more muscle relaxant D. Onset of block	Ans: B
Q39. TOF count of zero (no twitches visible) indicates: A. No neuromuscular block B. Intense (deep) neuromuscular block (>95% receptor occupation) C. Partial block only D. Equipment malfunction	Ans: B
Q40. Post-tetanic count (PTC) is used when: A. TOF shows 4 twitches B. TOF count is zero (intense block) to assess depth of profound block C. Patient is fully recovered D. No muscle relaxant has been given	Ans: B
Q41. Fade in TOF response is characteristic of: A. Depolarizing block (Phase I succinylcholine block) B. Non-depolarizing neuromuscular block C. No block at all D. Myasthenia gravis only	Ans: B
Q42. The Bispectral Index (BIS) monitor is used to assess: A. Neuromuscular blockade B. Depth of anesthesia/level of consciousness C. Blood pressure D. Oxygen saturation	Ans: B
Q43. The recommended BIS value range for adequate general anesthesia is: A. 80–100 B. 40–60 C. 0–20 D. 60–80	Ans: B
Q44. A BIS value of 100 indicates: A. Deep anesthesia B. Fully awake state C. Brain death D. Burst suppression	Ans: B

Q45. Evoked potential monitoring during anesthesia is used to assess: A. Blood pressure changes B. Integrity of neural pathways (spinal cord, brainstem, cortex) C. Muscle relaxation D. Temperature changes	Ans: B
Q46. Monitoring blood loss during surgery can be estimated by all EXCEPT: A. Weighing surgical swabs/sponges B. Measuring suction bottle contents C. Monitoring pulse oximetry alone D. Visual estimation and hemodynamic parameters	Ans: C
Q47. The formula for estimated blood loss by swab weighing is: A. Weight of dry swab minus weight of wet swab B. Weight of wet (blood-soaked) swab minus weight of dry swab (1 gram = 1 mL blood) C. Volume of suction divided by 2 D. Hematocrit multiplied by weight	Ans: B
Q48. Maximum allowable blood loss (MABL) depends on: A. Patient's height only B. Estimated blood volume, starting hematocrit, and minimum acceptable hematocrit C. Type of surgery only D. Duration of surgery	Ans: B
Q49. Urine output monitoring during surgery is a reliable indicator of: A. Depth of anesthesia B. Renal perfusion and adequacy of intravascular volume C. Neuromuscular blockade D. Blood glucose level	Ans: B
Q50. Which of the following is used as a point-of-care test to rapidly assess hemoglobin during surgery? A. CT scan B. HemoCue or arterial blood gas analyzer C. Pulse oximetry D. Capnography	Ans: B

Answer Key & Explanations

Q1. Answer: B — Observation of skin color, pupil size, and respiratory pattern

Clinical monitoring involves direct observation by the anesthesiologist including skin color, pupil size, chest movements, and peripheral perfusion without instruments.

Topic: Clinical Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q2. Answer: C — BIS value of 40–60

BIS monitoring is an instrumental (advanced) monitor, not a clinical sign. Clinical signs include stable vitals, pupil size, and absence of autonomic responses.

Topic: Clinical Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q3. Answer: B — Light anesthesia, hypoxia, or hypercarbia

Dilated pupils during anesthesia may indicate light anesthesia, hypoxia, hypercarbia, or sympathetic stimulation.

Topic: Clinical Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q4. Answer: D — Cardiac output monitoring

Minimum monitoring standards include pulse oximetry, ECG, NIBP, capnography, and temperature. Cardiac output monitoring is an advanced monitor used in select cases.

Topic: Advance Monitoring (Instrumental Monitoring) | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q5. Answer: B — Arrhythmias, ischemia, and heart rate

ECG monitoring detects cardiac rhythm disturbances, myocardial ischemia (ST changes), and heart rate during anesthesia.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q6. Answer: C — Lead V5

Lead V5 detects approximately 75% of intraoperative ST-segment changes indicative of left ventricular ischemia.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q7. Answer: B — P waves and inferior wall ischemia

Lead II provides the best P-wave visualization for rhythm analysis and detects inferior wall ischemia.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q8. Answer: B — Mean arterial pressure directly, then calculates systolic and diastolic

The oscillometric method directly measures mean arterial pressure (at maximum oscillation amplitude) and derives systolic and diastolic pressures.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q9. Answer: C — Minor ambulatory surgery in healthy patients

Invasive arterial monitoring is not indicated for minor ambulatory surgery in healthy patients. It is reserved for major surgeries and hemodynamically unstable patients.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q10. Answer: B — Radial artery

The radial artery is the most common site for arterial cannulation due to superficial location, good collateral circulation (ulnar artery), and accessibility.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q11. Answer: B — Adequacy of collateral circulation from the ulnar artery

Allen's test assesses the adequacy of ulnar artery collateral flow to the hand before radial artery cannulation.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q12. Answer: B — Junction of superior vena cava and right atrium

The CVP catheter tip should be at the junction of the SVC and right atrium for accurate pressure measurement.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q13. Answer: B — 2–8 mmHg (3–11 cm H₂O)

Normal CVP ranges from 2–8 mmHg (approximately 3–11 cm H₂O).

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q14. Answer: B — Right heart filling pressure and intravascular volume status

CVP reflects right atrial pressure, which indicates right heart filling pressure and helps guide fluid management.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q15. Answer: D — Intracranial pressure

The PA catheter measures PA pressures, PCWP, cardiac output, and mixed venous oxygen saturation. ICP requires a separate intracranial monitor.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q16. Answer: B — Left atrial pressure and left ventricular end-diastolic pressure

PCWP approximates left atrial pressure and hence left ventricular preload (LVEDP) in the absence of mitral valve disease.

Topic: Cardiovascular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 57

Q17. Answer: B — Functional oxygen saturation of hemoglobin (SpO₂)

Pulse oximetry measures the percentage of oxyhemoglobin (SpO₂) using spectrophotometric principles at two wavelengths.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q18. Answer: B — Beer-Lambert law (spectrophotometry with two wavelengths of light)

Pulse oximetry uses two wavelengths (660 nm red and 940 nm infrared) based on the Beer-Lambert law to determine oxygen saturation.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q19. Answer: B — Methylene blue dye injection

Methylene blue absorbs light at 660 nm, causing falsely low SpO₂ readings. Carbon monoxide causes falsely HIGH readings.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q20. Answer: B — End-tidal carbon dioxide (EtCO₂) concentration

Capnography continuously measures and displays the CO₂ concentration in expired gases, with EtCO₂ reflecting alveolar CO₂.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q21. Answer: B — 35–45 mmHg

Normal EtCO₂ is 35–45 mmHg, which is slightly lower than arterial PaCO₂ due to alveolar dead space.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q22. Answer: B — Circuit disconnection or esophageal intubation

A sudden drop of EtCO₂ to zero indicates circuit disconnection, extubation, or esophageal intubation (no alveolar gas being sampled).

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q23. Answer: B — Hypoventilation, increased CO₂ production (malignant hyperthermia), or rebreathing

Gradual EtCO₂ rise suggests hypoventilation, increased metabolic CO₂ production (e.g., malignant hyperthermia, fever), or CO₂ rebreathing.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q24. Answer: B — Infrared absorption spectroscopy

Capnographs use infrared absorption – CO₂ absorbs infrared light at a wavelength of 4.26 micrometers.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q25. Answer: B — The sensor is placed directly in the breathing circuit (at the airway)

Mainstream capnography places the sensor directly in the breathing circuit, providing faster response time but adding weight/dead space.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q26. Answer: D — Cardiac output

Intraoperative spirometry measures tidal volume, minute ventilation, flow rates, compliance, and resistance – not cardiac output.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q27. Answer: D — Myocardial ischemia

Airway pressure monitoring detects mechanical problems (disconnection, obstruction, bronchospasm, endobronchial intubation) but not myocardial ischemia.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q28. Answer: B — Paramagnetic or galvanic cell (fuel cell) principle

Oxygen analyzers use paramagnetic properties of O₂ or electrochemical (galvanic/fuel cell) principles to measure FiO₂.

Topic: Respiratory Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 61

Q29. Answer: B — 36–37.5°C

Core body temperature should be maintained between 36–37.5°C during anesthesia to avoid complications of hypothermia or hyperthermia.

Topic: Temperature Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 65

Q30. Answer: D — Axilla

The axilla measures peripheral (shell) temperature. Core temperature sites include nasopharynx, distal esophagus, tympanic membrane, and pulmonary artery.

Topic: Temperature Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 65

Q31. Answer: B — 36°C

Perioperative hypothermia is defined as core temperature below 36°C and is common during general anesthesia.

Topic: Temperature Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 65

Q32. Answer: D — Decreased duration of neuromuscular blockade

Hypothermia prolongs the duration of neuromuscular blockade (not decreases it). Other complications include coagulopathy, wound infection, and shivering.

Topic: Temperature Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 65

Q33. Answer: B — Rapid and unexplained rise in temperature with rising EtCO₂

Malignant hyperthermia presents with rapidly rising temperature, markedly elevated EtCO₂, muscle rigidity, and tachycardia.

Topic: Temperature Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 65

Q34. Answer: B — Heat redistribution from core to peripheral compartment due to vasodilation

Anesthetic-induced vasodilation causes redistribution of heat from the warm core to the cooler peripheral compartment, dropping core temperature rapidly in the first hour.

Topic: Temperature Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 65

Q35. Answer: B — Degree of neuromuscular blockade and recovery from muscle relaxants

Neuromuscular monitoring quantifies the degree of neuromuscular blockade and guides timing of reversal and extubation.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q36. Answer: B — Ulnar nerve (adductor pollicis response)

The ulnar nerve at the wrist is most commonly stimulated, and the response of the adductor pollicis muscle is observed.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q37. Answer: B — Four supramaximal stimuli at 2 Hz (every 0.5 seconds)

TOF consists of four supramaximal stimuli delivered at 2 Hz (0.5 second intervals), with the ratio of 4th to 1st twitch indicating block depth.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q38. Answer: B — Adequate recovery from neuromuscular blockade (safe to extubate)

A TOF ratio ≥ 0.9 indicates adequate recovery from neuromuscular blockade and is the threshold for safe extubation.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q39. Answer: B — Intense (deep) neuromuscular block (>95% receptor occupation)

Zero twitches on TOF indicates intense/deep block with greater than 95% of receptors occupied.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q40. Answer: B — TOF count is zero (intense block) to assess depth of profound block

PTC is used during intense block (TOF count = 0) to quantify the depth of block by counting post-tetanic facilitation twitches.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q41. Answer: B — Non-depolarizing neuromuscular block

Fade (progressive decrease in twitch height) is characteristic of non-depolarizing block. Phase I depolarizing block shows uniform decrease without fade.

Topic: Neuromuscular Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 66

Q42. Answer: B — Depth of anesthesia/level of consciousness

BIS is a processed EEG parameter that provides a numerical value (0–100) correlating with the depth of anesthesia/consciousness.

Topic: Central Nervous System (CNS) Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 68

Q43. Answer: B — 40–60

BIS values of 40–60 indicate adequate depth of general anesthesia with low probability of awareness.

Topic: Central Nervous System (CNS) Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 68

Q44. Answer: B — Fully awake state

BIS of 100 represents a fully awake state, while 0 represents EEG silence (isoelectric).

Topic: Central Nervous System (CNS) Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 68

Q45. Answer: B — Integrity of neural pathways (spinal cord, brainstem, cortex)

Evoked potentials (SSEP, MEP, BAEP) monitor the functional integrity of neural pathways during surgeries that risk neurological injury.

Topic: Central Nervous System (CNS) Monitoring | Ref: Ch 6, Page 68

Q46. Answer: C — Monitoring pulse oximetry alone

Pulse oximetry alone cannot estimate blood loss. Methods include swab weighing, suction measurement, visual estimation, and hemodynamic monitoring.

Topic: Monitoring Blood Loss | Ref: Ch 6, Page 69

Q47. Answer: B — Weight of wet (blood-soaked) swab minus weight of dry swab (1 gram = 1 mL blood)

Blood loss = (weight of blood-soaked swab – weight of dry swab) in grams, where 1 gram of blood ≈ 1 mL.

Topic: Monitoring Blood Loss | Ref: Ch 6, Page 69

Q48. Answer: B — Estimated blood volume, starting hematocrit, and minimum acceptable hematocrit

$MABL = EBV \times (\text{Starting Hct} - \text{Minimum acceptable Hct}) / \text{Starting Hct}$. It depends on blood volume and hematocrit values.

Topic: Monitoring Blood Loss | Ref: Ch 6, Page 69

Q49. Answer: B — Renal perfusion and adequacy of intravascular volume

Urine output (target ≥0.5 mL/kg/hr) reflects renal perfusion and is a useful guide to the adequacy of fluid resuscitation and cardiac output.

Topic: Monitoring Blood Loss | Ref: Ch 6, Page 69

Q50. Answer: B — HemoCue or arterial blood gas analyzer

HemoCue and ABG analyzers provide rapid point-of-care hemoglobin measurement to guide transfusion decisions intraoperatively.

Topic: Monitoring Blood Loss | Ref: Ch 6, Page 69